

HARSHAL ZALKE

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Vanderbilt University

Postdoctoral Scholar, Department of Political Science

2026-27

EDUCATION

Princeton University

PhD, Department of Politics

Fields: *Political Economy, Formal Theory and Quantitative Methods, International Relations*

Committee Members: *Kris Ramsay (Chair), Mehdi Shadmehr, Germán Gieczewski*

2026

The University of Texas at Austin

M.A., LBJ School of Public Affairs

2020

The University of Texas at Austin

M.S., Department of Operations Research and Industrial Engineering

2018

Visvesvaraya National Institute of Technology, India

B.Tech., Mechanical Engineering

2014

WORKING PAPERS

- “Coordinating Development Under Political Risk”
(with Mehdi Shadmehr)
– Under Review
- “Security Threats and the Screening of Investments”
(Job Market Paper)
– Presentations: APSA 2026 (Upcoming), MPSA 2026
- “Dynamic Screening with Hidden Harm”
(Dissertation Chapter)
- “The Geopolitics of Investment Screening: How Interstate Rivalry Shapes Market Access”
(Dissertation Chapter)
- “Strategic Investments and War Prevention”
– Presentations: MPSA 2025, APSA 2024, GSIPE 2024

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

- “The Value of Intelligence in Conflict”
(with Kris Ramsay)
– APSA 2026 (Upcoming), MPSA 2026
- “Optimal Sanctions Regime”

PRESENTATIONS

- American Political Science Association

2020, 2024, 2025
- Midwest Political Science Association

2024, 2025

- Graduate Students in International Political Economy Workshop 2024
- The Politics and Regulation of Investment Screening Mechanisms 2022

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

At Princeton:

- **POL 345: Introduction to Quantitative Social Science (U)**, (TA for Arthur Yu) Fall 2025
- **POL 396: International Organization (U)**, (TA for Jim Vreeland) Spring 2024
- **POL 572: Quantitative Analysis 1 (G)**, (TA for Rocio Titiumik) Spring 2023
- **POL 573: Quantitative Analysis 2 (G)**, (TA for Rocio Titiumik) Fall 2023

At UT Austin:

- **FIN 357: Business Finance (U)**, (TA for Robert Duvic) 2018 - 2020
- **STA 380: Mathematical Statistics for Applications (G)**, (TA for Thomas Sager) Fall 2017
- **PHY 103M: Laboratory for Physics (U)**, Spring 2017

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Research Assistant for Helen Milner, *Princeton University* Summer 2022
- Research Assistant for Layna Mosley, *Princeton University* Spring 2021
- Research Assistant for Catherine Weaver, *The University of Texas at Austin* 2019 - 2020

PROFESSION EXPERIENCE

- Summer Intern, *Carnegie Council for Ethics in International Affairs* Summer 2019
- Sr. Engineer (Supply Chain), *Bajaj Auto Ltd* 2014 - 2016

FELLOWSHIPS AND HONORS

- Dean's Completion Fellowship, *Princeton University* 2025-2026
- The John Fayerweather '43 Graduate Fellowship, *Princeton University* 2023-2024
- Quantitative and Analytical Political Science Fellow, *Princeton University* 2022-2026
- Niehaus Center for Globalization and Governance, *Princeton University* 2020-2021
- Lyndon Baines Johnson Foundation Fellowship, *UT Austin* Spring 2019
- Charls and Harmolyn Walker Public Policy Excellence Fund Fellowship, *UT Austin* Summer 2019

REFERENCES

- **Kristopher Ramsay**
Professor
Department of Politics, Princeton University
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609-258-2960
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- **Mehdi Shadmehr**
Associate Professor
Department of Public Policy, UNC Chapel Hill
mshadmeh@gmail.com

- **Germán Gieczewski**

Associate Professor

Department of Politics, Princeton University

311 Fisher Hall

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- **Layna Mosley**

Professor

School of Public and International Affairs and Department of Politics, Princeton University

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